

TEST 4

Part 1

Question	Answer	Location	Explain
1	club	Speaker A: We do that at the clubhouse in Wynne. It's behind the playing fields. Speaker A: It used to be a cricket club, you see.	- Đáp án là club - “clubhouse” → The ____ House → club house - Đề đã cho “House” nên điền “club” - Key word: + clubhouse (n): nhà câu lạc bộ + cricket club (n): CLB cricket
2	male	Speaker A: Oh, that's great. We're always looking for actors and singers, of course, especially male ones. Speaker A: Oh, by the way, do you have a car?	- Đáp án là male - “especially male ones” → singers nam - Khớp với “____ singers” - Key word: + male (adj): nam + singers (n): ca sĩ
3	drive	Speaker A: It's a big help if you're able to drive. Not all our members have access to transport, so it's very helpful. Speaker B: I see. Well, I'm sure I can help out there.	- Đáp án là drive - “able to drive” → biết lái xe - Khớp “people who can ____” - Key word: + drive (v): lái xe + transport (n): phương tiện
4	Tuesday	Speaker A: On Tuesday from 6 till 8pm. Speaker B: Sorry, you said Tuesday, not Thursday.	- Đáp án là Tuesday - Ngày họp được nhắc rõ - Key word: + Tuesday (n): thứ Ba + meet (v): gặp
5	August	Speaker A: Good point. We do close for a couple of weeks, you know, in August, so we don't get together then. Before you hear the rest of the conversation, you have some time to look at questions 6 to 10.	- Đáp án là August - “close... in August” → đóng cửa tháng 8 - Khớp “Closed in ...” - Key word: + close (v): đóng + August (n): tháng 8

6	dinner	Speaker A: Yes, and that covers our annual dinner. Speaker B: Right.	- Đáp án là dinner - “covers our annual dinner” → bao gồm bữa tối hàng năm - Key word: + annual (adj): hàng năm + dinner (n): bữa tối
7	25	Speaker A: It was 10%, but now it's more. You pay just £25, which is a reduction of £15. Speaker B: Every little helps after all, especially with a teenage son.	- Đáp án là 25 - Giá ưu đãi: £25 - Key word: + pay (v): trả + reduction (n): giảm
8	16	Speaker A: Actually, we have a special youth group, and that's open to anyone up to and including 16 years old. Speaker B: Great. Keep him out of trouble.	- Đáp án là 16 - “up to and including 16” → tối đa 16 tuổi - Key word: + youth group (n): nhóm thanh thiếu niên + including (prep): bao gồm
9	modern	Speaker A: Occasionally we might do Shakespeare, but normally we choose works by modern playwrights. Speaker B: Sounds quite varied.	- Đáp án là modern - “modern playwrights” → tác giả hiện đại - Khớp “plays by ____ authors” - Key word: + modern (adj): hiện đại + playwrights (n): nhà viết kịch
10	hospital	Speaker A: We donate the money we make to the children's hospital here. Speaker B: Well, oh, that sounds very nice.	- Đáp án là hospital - “children's hospital” → bệnh viện trẻ em - Khớp “children's ____” - Key word: + hospital (n): bệnh viện + donate (v): quyên góp

Now turn to part one on page two of your question booklet.

Part one.

You will hear a telephone conversation between a man who wants to join an amateur dramatic society and the society secretary.

First you have some time to look at questions one to five. Now listen carefully and answer questions one to five.

Speaker A: Hello, how can I help you?

Speaker B: Hi, I've just moved to the area and saw an advertisement for your drama society, so I'm calling to find out some more details.

Speaker A: Sure. I'm the society secretary. My name's Jane Caulfield.

Speaker B: Thanks. Can you tell me exactly where the society is based?

Speaker A: Well, the address for the society is my address, which is 117 Green Road, like the colour, and that's in Prestwyn. But that's just the mailing address. It's not where we actually rehearse.

Speaker A: We do that at the clubhouse in Wynne. It's behind the playing fields. It used to be a cricket club, you see.

Speaker B: Oh, right.

Speaker A: So is this a new interest or do you have some acting experience? It doesn't matter if you haven't, you know. Experience isn't a requirement.

Speaker B: Well, that's good because I haven't got any, but I am musical and I've got some experience of song festivals.

Speaker A: Oh, that's great. We're always looking for actors and singers, of course, especially male ones.

Speaker A: Oh, by the way, do you have a car?

Speaker B: Yes. Why?

Speaker A: It's a big help if you're able to drive. Not all our members have access to transport, so it's very helpful.

Speaker B: I see. Well, I'm sure I can help out there.

Speaker B: So when do you actually meet?

Speaker A: On Tuesday from 6 till 8pm.

Speaker B: Sorry, you said Tuesday, not Thursday.

Speaker A: Yes.

Speaker B: Good. Thursdays are a problem for me. I do some private tutoring and can't move that.

Speaker A: Right.

Speaker B: And that's all year, no breaks.

Speaker A: Good point. We do close for a couple of weeks, you know, in August, so we don't get together then.

Before you hear the rest of the conversation, you have some time to look at questions 6 to 10. Now listen and answer questions 6 to 10.

Speaker B: And is there a joining fee?

Speaker A: To be a member costs just £40.

Speaker B: A year?

Speaker A: Yes, and that covers our annual dinner.

Speaker B: Right.

Speaker A: But there's a rate for concessions, which are for people over 60 and the unemployed.

Speaker B: I've just retired, so that's good news. What's the discount?

Speaker A: It was 10%, but now it's more. You pay just £25, which is a reduction of £15.

Speaker B: Every little helps after all, especially with a teenage son.

Speaker B: Actually, I wanted to ask if there's an age limit. Could Jack come along too? He's 15.

Speaker A: Actually, we have a special youth group, and that's open to anyone up to and including 16 years old. So he could join that.

Speaker B: Great. Keep him out of trouble.

Speaker B: And what about the shows you put on? You said you were very busy. Do you have plays, etc., every year? Or how does it work?

Speaker A: Well, we put on at least two productions a year. Occasionally we might do Shakespeare, but normally we choose works by modern playwrights.

Speaker B: Sounds quite varied. And challenging. And you rehearse for the two productions when you meet up?

Speaker A: Certainly. But that's not all we do. We also write our own family show each winter for the December holidays, which is always a lot of fun and is actually very popular in the local community. We donate the money we make to the children's hospital here.

Speaker B: Well, oh, that sounds very nice. I've been involved in...

That is the end of Part 1. You now have one minute to check your answers to Part 1.

Part 2

Question	Answer	Location	Explain
11	A	<i>For some species that we have here, there aren't many still alive in the wild. So a big part of our job is to make sure we help their numbers increase.</i>	- Đáp án là A - “aren’t many still alive in the wild” → loài đang bị đe dọa - Nhấn mạnh bảo tồn - B sai vì không nói birds from all over the world - C sai vì không nói common local birds - Key word: + alive (adj): còn sống + increase (v): tăng lên
12	B	<i>If you want to help, you can choose which day, although we do already have plenty of volunteers working Saturdays and Sundays. But one day every four weeks is the minimum commitment that we ask for.</i>	- Đáp án là B - “one day every four weeks” → ít nhất 1 lần/tháng - A sai vì không bắt buộc weekend - C sai vì làm quanh năm - Key word: + minimum (adj): tối thiểu + commitment (n): cam kết
13	B	<i>But we're looking more for people who are flexible in turn-up no matter whether it's raining or baking hot. That's what'll make you the best person for the job.</i>	- Đáp án là B - “no matter whether it's raining or baking hot” → làm trong mọi thời tiết - A sai vì không nhấn mạnh independent - C sai vì knowledge không quan trọng bằng thái độ - Key word: + flexible (adj): linh hoạt + weather (n): thời tiết
14	A	<i>In general, it's people in a foreign tour group that you're responsible for. The Clifton residents who come to the park usually know their way around.</i>	- Đáp án là A - “foreign tour group” → khách quốc tế - B sai vì local không cần hướng dẫn - C sai vì school groups do park officers phụ trách - Key word: + foreign (adj): nước ngoài + tour group (n): đoàn du lịch
15	B	<i>If anyone is able to drive some other volunteers to the event, please let me know because we need help there. The park officers will provide you with spades and drills and hammers, all of that stuff.</i>	- Đáp án là B - “need help... drive” → cần hỗ trợ vận chuyển - A sai vì refreshments đã có - C sai vì tools đã được cung cấp - Key word: + drive (v): lái xe + provide (v): cung cấp

16	F	<i>On the southern side of Clifton Lane is one of our car parks and below that, there are two similar sized ponds. The wooden bridge runs between those two ponds.</i>	- Đáp án là F - “between two ponds” → vị trí giữa 2 hồ - Trên map là F - Key word: + bridge (n): cầu + between (prep): giữa
17	H	<i>The tower's in the south-east corner of the map. You see there are two different sized ponds there. The tower's on the south side of the larger pond at the end of the path.</i>	- Đáp án là H - “south-east corner” + “south side of large pond” - Khớp vị trí H - Key word: + tower (n): tháp + corner (n): góc
18	C	<i>There's the woods and on the left-hand side of the map, the railway line. The visitors' cabins are marked there, between the woods and the railway station.</i>	- Đáp án là C - “between woods and railway station” - Trên map là C - Key word: + cabins (n): cabin + between (prep): giữa
19	G	<i>See the picnic area? The path you want is between there and the big pond. Follow it round all the way to the end. So, as we're looking at the map now, the nesting boxes are on the right of that pond.</i>	- Đáp án là G - “on the right of that pond” → vị trí bên phải hồ - Trên map là G - Key word: + nesting boxes (n): tổ chim + right (n): bên phải
20	B	<i>Towards the top of the map, you've got that smallish pond quite near the railway line and there are two places marked up there. The boat sheds are on the same side of the pond as the woods, not the place marked at the tip of the park.</i>	- Đáp án là B - “same side as woods” → cùng phía rừng - Loại vị trí “tip of park” - Key word: + sheds (n): nhà kho + woods (n): rừng

Part 2

You will hear a woman called Sandra Hayes who works at a bird park talking to a group of people who want to volunteer there.

First you have some time to look at questions 11 to 15. Now listen carefully and answer questions 11 to 15.

Hello, my name is Sandra Hayes and I'm from Clifton Bird Park. It's great to see so many possible volunteers here. The park is now a very popular attraction in this area.

I think people love coming to see so many different types of birds in a beautiful environment. For some species that we have here, there aren't many still alive in the wild. So a big part of our job is to make sure we help their numbers increase.

All the birds are native species.

We need volunteers to help the bird park officers with different jobs. One of these is gardening. Obviously summer is the time when we have most visitors, but the park needs looking after all year round.

If you want to help, you can choose which day, although we do already have plenty of volunteers working Saturdays and Sundays. But one day every four weeks is the minimum commitment that we ask for.

So, who's the ideal volunteer for gardening work? If you have expert knowledge about flowers and trees, great. But we're looking more for people who are flexible in turn-up no matter whether it's raining or baking hot. That's what'll make you the best person for the job. It's all teamwork, so you'll have plenty of support.

What about volunteer guides? A guide's role is to point out the birds and talk about the conservation program. In general, it's people in a foreign tour group that you're responsible for. The Clifton residents who come to the park usually know their way around. We get a few teachers bringing in classes, but they're the park officer's responsibility.

The last thing to mention is the park's maintenance day, which is coming up soon. We're hoping to get as many volunteers as possible to come and help tidy things up. If anyone is able to drive some other volunteers to the event, please let me know because we need help there. The park officers will provide you with spades and drills and hammers, all of that stuff. And they'll be offering you some refreshments too, so it should be a good day out.

Before you hear the rest of the talk, you have some time to look at questions 16 to 20. Now listen and answer questions 16 to 20.

So, here's a map of Clifton Bird Park. As you can see, the railway line runs along the north-west of the park and road access is on that side too, from Clifton Lane.

We want volunteers to work on a few different areas on maintenance day, which is coming up soon. Firstly, the wooden bridge. I'll explain where that is. You can see Clifton Lane and the main gate into the park. On the southern side of Clifton Lane is one of our car parks and below that, there are

two similar sized ponds. The wooden bridge runs between those two ponds. We just need to make it a bit stronger.

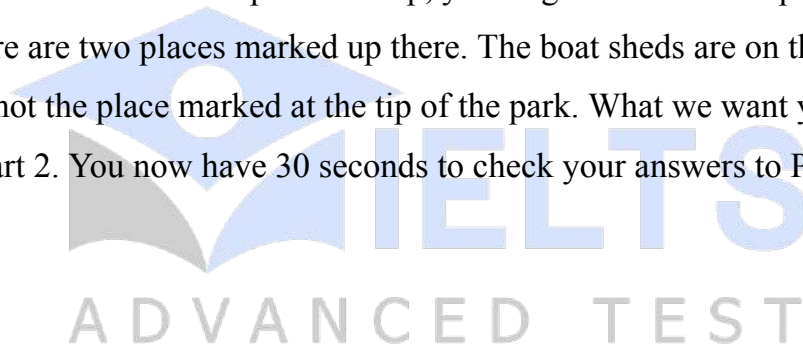
Some volunteers will be doing a bit of painting at the observation tower. The tower's in the south-east corner of the map. You see there are two different sized ponds there. The tower's on the south side of the larger pond at the end of the path. We'll need about three people to help out.

We need to replace the windows and the visitor cabins. So, on the map, you can see our car park on the north side of Clifton Lane. There's the woods and on the left-hand side of the map, the railway line. The visitors' cabins are marked there, between the woods and the railway station.

You'll also be repairing some nesting boxes. See the picnic area? The path you want is between there and the big pond. Follow it round all the way to the end. So, as we're looking at the map now, the nesting boxes are on the right of that pond.

Finally, the boat sheds. Towards the top of the map, you've got that smallish pond quite near the railway line and there are two places marked up there. The boat sheds are on the same side of the pond as the woods, not the place marked at the tip of the park. What we want you to do...

That is the end of Part 2. You now have 30 seconds to check your answers to Part 2.



Part 3

Question	Answer	Location	Explain
21	A	Speaker B: Yes, the country code is mainly just common sense, so let's include the mountain one. That's what they need to know about for geology. Speaker A: Then there are similar guidelines for caving, but they won't need those in the part of Iceland we're going to.	- Đáp án là A - “that's what they need to know about for geology” → phù hợp nhất với chuyến đi - B sai vì họ nói không cần caving guidelines - C sai vì không đề cập “whole country” - Key word: + need to know (phr): cần biết + geology (n): địa chất
22	C	Speaker B: Actually, what I think happens is that they all become so focused on what they're doing that they forget about other things around them. It's not intentional damage. Speaker A: And we have to include something about collecting samples.	- Đáp án là C - “so focused... forget about other things” → quá tập trung vào công việc - A sai vì không nói không nhận ra plant species - B sai vì không nói fragile environment - Key word: + focused (adj): tập trung + forget (v): quên
23	C	Speaker B: For example, only take minute samples and only if necessary. Speaker A: Yes, that's the golden rule. That has to come first and then I guess never take a fossil away from the area.	- Đáp án là C - “only take minute samples” → lấy ít nhất có thể - Đây là “golden rule” → quan trọng nhất - A và B là quy tắc khác nhưng không phải chính - Key word: + minute (adj): nhỏ + necessary (adj): cần thiết
24	C	Speaker A: And there's something we still have to find out about. Isn't there something about how you can never take a sample from a wall? Speaker B: You mean a man-made wall or something like a natural rock face?	- Đáp án là C - “man-made wall” → cấu trúc nhân tạo - Họ chưa chắc → cần tìm hiểu thêm - Key word: + wall (n): tường + man-made (adj): nhân tạo
25	B	Speaker B: But when people are working on the seashore, they often fail to notice that the tides come in and they're cut off by water. That's what we should make a point about. Speaker A: OK.	- Đáp án là B - “tides come in... cut off” → thủy triều nguy hiểm - A, C chỉ là dấu hiệu dễ nhận ra nên không nhấn mạnh - Key word: + tides (n): thủy triều + cut off (phr): bị cô lập

26	D	Speaker B: No, it deals with harnessing the heat generated from the earth in geothermal areas to grow vegetables for local consumption. They'll need to understand the geological characteristics that make this possible.	- Đáp án là D - “grow vegetables” → năng lượng cho nông nghiệp - Key word: + grow (v): trồng + vegetables (n): rau
27	A	Speaker A: It's the existence of the hotspot that explains the rock formations of this island and makes it unlike any of the others. Speaker B: Now I definitely think they should read the pack about glaciers.	- Đáp án là A - “makes it unlike any of the others” → đặc điểm địa chất độc đáo - Key word: + rock formations (n): cấu trúc đá + unlike (adj): khác biệt
28	F	Speaker B: if anything happens to make the glaciers melt suddenly, the water produced pours down the valleys and it can mean that whole villages suddenly have to be evacuated. Speaker A: Right.	- Đáp án là F - “water pours down... villages evacuated” → nguy cơ lũ lụt - Key word: + melt (v): tan chảy + evacuated (v): sơ tán
29	G	Speaker B: Then the basalt rock pack shows how Iceland's landscape, like many other islands, has been moulded over millions of years by lava flows from volcanic eruptions, especially the area in the northwest of the island. Speaker A: And lastly, reading about geothermal power plants will inform them of Iceland's plan to stop using energy derived from carbon in the future.	- Đáp án là G - “over millions of years... lava flows” → tác động lâu dài của núi lửa - Key word: + lava (n): dung nham + eruptions (n): phun trào
30	B	Speaker A: And lastly, reading about geothermal power plants will inform them of Iceland's plan to stop using energy derived from carbon in the future. Heating and electricity will come from sustainable sources which won't cause any pollution.	- Đáp án là B - “stop using energy derived from carbon” → thay thế nhiên liệu hóa thạch - Key word: + carbon (n): carbon + sustainable (adj): bền vững

Part 3. You will hear two teachers called Andrew and Sarah discussing how to prepare students for a geology field trip.

First you have some time to look at questions 21 to 25. Now listen carefully and answer questions 21 to 25.

Speaker A: Hi Sarah, it's great that we've got some free time this afternoon to decide what advice to give when we talk to the students on the geology field trip to Iceland.

Speaker B: Hi Andrew, yes, I've already jotted down a few ideas about the issues that come up on these trips. We should include something about existing rules and laws that apply, like the country code.

Speaker A: Or the mountain code.

Speaker B: Yes, the country code is mainly just common sense, so let's include the mountain one. That's what they need to know about for geology.

Speaker A: Then there are similar guidelines for caving, but they won't need those in the part of Iceland we're going to.

Speaker B: OK.

Speaker A: Right, let's think about when they're on site and looking after the environment. I don't mean not dropping litter, that's obvious, or like closing gates. But what about not scaring birds or damaging rare plant life?

Speaker B: Actually, what I think happens is that they all become so focused on what they're doing that they forget about other things around them. It's not intentional damage.

Speaker A: And we have to include something about collecting samples. That's vital for geology students.

Speaker B: Yeah, there's quite a list of rules about that. For example, only take minute samples and only if necessary.

Speaker A: Yes, that's the golden rule. That has to come first and then I guess never take a fossil away from the area.

Speaker B: And when you do disturb an area to take a sample, make sure you leave it as you found it.

Speaker A: OK. And there's something we still have to find out about. Isn't there something about how you can never take a sample from a wall?

Speaker B: You mean a man-made wall or something like a natural rock face?

Speaker A: A wall, like of a building.

Speaker B: Don't you just have to get permission from the owner? But I'm not sure, to be honest, so we need to check that.

Speaker A: Another really important thing is advice on safety, especially as a lot of our trips are along the coast.

Speaker B: Yes, well, you can usually hear if any large boulders start to tumble down a cliff. And you realise you're on soft sand when you start sinking. But when people are working on the seashore, they often fail to notice that the tides come in and they're cut off by water. That's what we should make a point about.

Speaker A: OK.

Before you hear the rest of the discussion, you have some time to look at questions 26 to 30. Now listen and answer questions 26 to 30.

Speaker A: Before we do anything else, could we just talk about the reading packs we put together for the students to read before they go on the field trip to Iceland?

Speaker B: Absolutely. They'll need to do most of the reading beforehand because there won't be time while we're away and there's a lot of technical data. That's certainly the case in the pack called geothermal fields.

Speaker A: Does that cover industrial uses of geothermal energy?

Speaker B: No, it deals with harnessing the heat generated from the earth in geothermal areas to grow vegetables for local consumption. They'll need to understand the geological characteristics that make this possible.

Speaker A: Right. The reading pack called the hotspot will help them understand how Iceland differs from other islands formed at the same time, like Bermuda and the Canary Islands. It's the existence of the hotspot that explains the rock formations of this island and makes it unlike any of the others.

Speaker B: Now I definitely think they should read the pack about glaciers. They need to be aware that although the ice and glaciers up in the mountains can stay frozen for thousands of years, if anything happens to make the glaciers melt suddenly, the water produced pours down the valleys and it can mean that whole villages suddenly have to be evacuated.

Speaker A: Right.

Speaker B: Then the basalt rock pack shows how Iceland's landscape, like many other islands, has been moulded over millions of years by lava flows from volcanic eruptions, especially the area in the northwest of the island.

Speaker A: And lastly, reading about geothermal power plants will inform them of Iceland's plan to stop using energy derived from carbon in the future. Heating and electricity will come from sustainable sources which won't cause any pollution.

Speaker B: I think that'll be all the reading they'll have time for.

That is the end of part three. You now have 30 seconds to check your answers to part three.

Part 4

Question	Answer	Location	Explain
31	power	<i>The umbrella was once regarded as a power icon of authority among leaders. More than just a practical item for shade or rain protection, it was a status symbol.</i>	- Đáp án là power - “power icon of authority” → biểu tượng quyền lực - Khớp với “symbolized ___ for rulers” - Key word: + power (n): quyền lực + authority (n): quyền uy
32	women	<i>In ancient Rome, umbrellas were considered a luxury accessible only to wealthy women. Owning an umbrella was a clear sign of wealth and high social rank.</i>	- Đáp án là women - “accessible only to wealthy women” → chỉ phụ nữ giàu có - Khớp trực tiếp đề - Key word: + women (n): phụ nữ + wealthy (adj): giàu có
33	bone	<i>Meanwhile, in India, umbrellas were made from bone and sometimes by wood, which were readily available and commonly used, showing the resourcefulness of the people. To make umbrellas more effective in the rain, they were coated with wax.</i>	- Đáp án là bone - “made from bone” → vật liệu địa phương - Khớp với đề - Key word: + bone (n): xương + material (n): vật liệu
34	wax	<i>To make umbrellas more effective in the rain, they were coated with wax. This process made them waterproof, greatly enhancing their functionality.</i>	- Đáp án là wax - “coated with wax” → phủ sáp chống nước - Khớp “treated with ... waterproof” - Key word: + wax (n): sáp + waterproof (adj): chống nước

35	body	<i>Originally, umbrellas were used to shield the body not just from rain, but also from the sun and other natural elements. Their use was crucial for those needing all-around protection when outside.</i>	- Đáp án là body - “shield the body” → bảo vệ cơ thể - Khớp với đề - Key word: + body (n): cơ thể + shield (v): che chắn
36	lids	<i>In their early designs, umbrellas resembled oversized lids. They were large and dome-shaped, which allowed them to cover a good amount of space, providing ample protection from the elements.</i>	- Đáp án là lids - “resembled oversized lids” → giống nắp lớn - Khớp trực tiếp - Key word: + lids (n): nắp + resembled (v): giống
37	gloves	<i>Umbrellas were frequently paired with gloves, especially with colder or rainier climates. This combination provided not only practical benefits, but also a touch of elegance to the wearer's outfit.</i>	- Đáp án là gloves - “paired with gloves” → đi kèm găng tay - Khớp với đề - Key word: + gloves (n): găng tay + paired (v): kết hợp
38	plastic	<i>A major change took place in the 1850s when umbrellas started being manufactured with plastic. This change made them lighter to carry and more durable against wear and tear.</i>	- Đáp án là plastic - “manufactured with plastic” → vật liệu mới - Khớp với đề - Key word: + plastic (n): nhựa + durable (adj): bền
39	steel	<i>However, in England, the use of steel for umbrella frames represented a significant advancement because these materials can make umbrellas much sturdier and capable of withstanding strong winds and harsh weather.</i>	- Đáp án là steel - “frames... made of steel” → khung bằng thép - Khớp với đề - Key word: + steel (n): thép + frames (n): khung
40	nylon	<i>Lastly, in Germany, the transition to using nylon for umbrellas represented another key development. This material was chosen for its lightweight and waterproof qualities.</i>	- Đáp án là nylon - “using nylon” → vật liệu cải tiến - Khớp với đề - Key word: + nylon (n): nylon + lightweight (adj): nhẹ

Part 4. You will hear a lecture on the history of the umbrella. First you have some time to look at questions 31 to 40. Listen carefully and answer questions 31 to 40.

Today I will share the captivating story of the umbrella. This common item has a rich history that spans across various cultures around the world. It's more than just a tool to stay dry in the rain. It has played a significant role in history and society.

The umbrella was once regarded as a power icon of authority among leaders. More than just a practical item for shade or rain protection, it was a status symbol. Carried majestically over the heads of kings and powerful leaders during parades and public gatherings, it showcased their authority and ruling power to the people watching.

In ancient Rome, umbrellas were considered a luxury accessible only to wealthy women. Owning an umbrella was a clear sign of wealth and high social rank. This made the umbrella a prestigious item, only accessible to those at the top of the social ladder, and it was seen as an exclusive accessory among the elite.

The materials used for making umbrellas varied greatly depending on where they were made. In China, umbrellas were elegantly crafted from silk, demonstrating the artisan's skill and the cultural appreciation for beauty. Meanwhile, in India, umbrellas were made from bone and sometimes by wood, which were readily available and commonly used, showing the resourcefulness of the people. To make umbrellas more effective in the rain, they were coated with wax. This process made them waterproof, greatly enhancing their functionality. By adding this simple but clever modification, umbrellas became more reliable and effective at keeping the rain off, thereby becoming a more essential tool for anyone stepping outside in wet weather.

Originally, umbrellas were used to shield the body not just from rain, but also from the sun and other natural elements. Their use was crucial for those needing all-around protection when outside, which made the umbrella a critical item for outdoor activities.

In their early designs, umbrellas resembled oversized lids. They were large and dome-shaped, which allowed them to cover a good amount of space, providing ample protection from the elements. This design has greatly influenced the development of modern umbrellas, which still retain a similar shape for maximum coverage.

Umbrellas were frequently paired with gloves, especially with colder or rainier climates. This combination provided not only practical benefits, but also a touch of elegance to the wearer's outfit. It allowed people to stay dry and warm, making those an essential pair for outdoor wear.

A major change took place in the 1850s when umbrellas started being manufactured with plastic. This change made them lighter to carry and more durable against wear and tear, and much easier for everyone to use.

However, in England, the use of steel for umbrella frames represented a significant advancement because these materials can make umbrellas much sturdier and capable of withstanding strong winds and harsh weather. This change was particularly important in England, where the weather can often be unpredictable and windy.

Lastly, in Germany, the transition to using nylon for umbrellas represented another key development. This material was chosen for its lightweight and waterproof qualities, offered significant advantages. It made umbrellas easier to carry and more effective in keeping people dry, boosting their popularity in various climates and conditions.

That's the end of Part 4. You now have half a minute to check your answers.

